VOL5

VOLUME 5

Cognitive Activities

120 stimulating cognitive exercises for memory, attention, language, and executive function.

120 Exercises | 4 Sections | Cognitive Focus | All Levels

SENIOR ACTIVITY VAULT · PROFESSIONAL EDITION



SECTION 1

Memory & Recall

Shopping list memory, name recall, story retelling, and sequence memory to maintain and strengthen working and long-term memory.

- List and item recall
- Name and story memory
- Visual and sequence tasks
- Delayed recall challenges



Shopping List Memory

★ Independent

Memorise a short shopping list and recall it after a brief distraction.

1. Read 5 items slowly: milk, bread, eggs, apples, cheese.
2. Distraction: count to 20 backward.
3. Recall all 5 items aloud.
4. Add one item each session.

Name Recall Round

★ Independent

Learn each group member's name and an associated fact.

1. Each person says name and one fact: 'I am Pat; I love gardening'.
2. Go around twice.
3. After a pause, each person recalls one name-fact pair.
4. Score 1 for each correct pair.

Story Retelling

★ Independent

Listen to a short story and retell key events in order.

1. Facilitator reads a 3-sentence story.
2. Participants listen without notes.
3. Each person retells one event in sequence.
4. Discuss: what was hardest to remember?

Sequence Memory

★★ Assisted

Memorise a sequence of 4–6 coloured objects and repeat the order.

1. Line up 5 coloured blocks or cards.
2. Participants study sequence 30 seconds.
3. Cover the sequence.
4. Each person recalls order aloud.

Number Chain

★ Independent

Memorise an increasing string of numbers and repeat them forward and backward.

1. Start with 3 digits: 5, 8, 2.
2. Participants repeat forward.
3. Repeat backward: 2, 8, 5.
4. Add one digit each round.

Object Tray Memory

★ Independent

Study a tray of objects, then identify what was removed.

1. Display 8 common objects on tray.
2. Participants study 30 seconds.
3. Cover tray; remove one object.
4. Uncover; participants identify missing item.

Word-Image Pairing

★★ Assisted

Match word cards to picture cards after a brief study period.

1. Lay out 6 word-picture pairs; study 1 minute.
2. Turn all cards face down.
3. Turn over one word; find its matching picture.
4. Score 1 per correct pair.

Delayed Recall Task

★★ Assisted

Memorise 5 words, then recall them 10 minutes later.

1. Read 5 unrelated words: hat, river, candle, fence, blue.
2. Continue with other activities for 10 minutes.
3. Ask participants to recall all 5 words.
4. Discuss strategies used.

Facial Recognition

★ Independent

Study photos of 5 unfamiliar faces with names and recall pairings.

1. Show 5 photo-name pairs for 1 minute.
2. Turn photos over.
3. Show photos one at a time; recall names.
4. Score 1 per correct name.

Backwards Name Spell

★★ Assisted

Spell a familiar word backward to challenge working memory.

1. Facilitator says a 4-letter word: 'word'.
2. Participant spells it forward first.
3. Then spells it backward: D-R-O-W.
4. Progress to 5- and 6-letter words.

Route Memory

★★ Assisted

Memorise a simple 4-step route described verbally and trace it on paper.

1. Facilitator describes: turn left, go forward two blocks, turn right, stop.
2. Participants listen without notes.
3. Draw route on a grid paper.
4. Compare drawings; discuss differences.

Colour Pattern Memory

★ Independent

Memorise the order of 5 coloured squares shown briefly.

1. Flash 5 coloured squares in order (5 seconds).
2. Cover the sequence.
3. Participants arrange matching coloured cards in order.
4. Score 1 if fully correct.

Day and Date Recall

★ Independent

Recall today's day, date, month, and year to orientate memory.

1. Ask: what day is it today?
2. What is the date?
3. What month?
4. What year? Discuss if uncertain.

News Event Recall

★★ Assisted

Listen to 3 news items read aloud and recall key facts.

1. Facilitator reads 3 simple news-style sentences.
2. Participants listen without notes.
3. After a 5-minute pause, ask specific questions.
4. Score 1 per correct fact recalled.

Mirror Drawing Memory

★★ Assisted

Study a simple drawing, then reproduce it from memory.

1. Show a simple line drawing for 30 seconds.
2. Remove drawing.
3. Participants draw what they remember.
4. Compare to original; discuss differences.

Grocery Category Sort

★ Independent

Recall which shopping items belong to which category from a mixed list.

1. Read 10 items: apple, soap, milk, pen, broccoli, shampoo, pear, paper, yoghurt, ruler.
2. After 5 minutes, ask: which were food items?
3. Which were household/stationery items?
4. Score categories correctly identified.

Phone Number Recall

★ Independent

Memorise a 7-digit phone number after hearing it once.

1. Read: 'The number is 4-7-2-9-0-3-1'.
2. Participants repeat it back immediately.
3. After a 2-minute distraction, ask again.
4. Discuss memory strategies: chunking, rhyme.

Action Sequence

★★ Assisted

Watch 4 simple actions performed in order and repeat them.

1. Facilitator performs: tap table, clap, cross arms, nod head.
2. Participants watch carefully.
3. Reproduce the 4 actions in order.
4. Add one action per round.

Paired-Associate Learning

★★ Assisted

Learn word pairs and recall the second word when given the first.

1. Read 5 pairs: dog-chair, moon-pencil, green-table.
2. Study 1 minute.
3. Facilitator says first word of each pair.
4. Participants supply the second word.

Story Elements Recall

★ Independent

Listen to a short passage and recall character, setting, and key event.

1. Facilitator reads a 5-sentence passage.
2. Ask: who was the main character?
3. Where did the story take place?
4. What was the main event?

Landmark Location Memory

★★ Assisted

Study a simple hand-drawn map and recall where 5 landmarks are placed.

1. Show map with 5 labelled landmarks for 1 minute.
2. Cover map.
3. Ask: where is the post office?
4. Score 1 per correct location recalled.

Three-Word Distraction Task

★ Independent

Hold 3 words in mind while completing a different task, then recall them.

1. Give 3 words to remember: ocean, clock, umbrella.
2. Complete 2 minutes of another activity.
3. Recall the 3 words.
4. Progress to 4 and 5 words.

List Chunking

★ Independent

Learn a 9-item list by chunking into three groups of three.

1. Read list: pen, bread, hat, milk, cup, coat, book, egg, shoe.
2. Suggest grouping: office, food, clothing.
3. Study 1 minute by category.
4. Recall full list.

People and Professions

★ Independent

Match famous names to their professions from a mixed set.

1. Provide 8 name cards and 8 profession cards.
2. Study pairings for 1 minute.
3. Shuffle cards.
4. Match names to professions from memory.

Morning Routine Recall

★ Independent

Recall and order the steps of your own morning routine.

1. Ask each person to list their morning routine.
2. Write steps in whatever order they recall.
3. Review: are they in the right order?
4. Discuss: any steps usually forgotten?

Vocabulary Retention

★★ Assisted

Learn 4 new vocabulary words and recall definitions the following session.

1. Introduce 4 interesting words with definitions.
2. Use each in a sentence.
3. Practice recalling definitions.
4. Revisit at start of next session.

Sequential Instruction Memory

★★ Assisted

Listen to 4 sequential task instructions and carry them out in order.

1. Facilitator says: stand up, walk to the window, pick up the pen, return.
2. Listen without writing.
3. Carry out instructions in order.
4. Discuss: which step was most often missed?

Memory for Appointments

★ Independent

Practise remembering a future appointment through rehearsal.

1. Tell participants: 'You have a doctor appointment Tuesday at 2 pm'.
2. Discuss strategies: calendar, alarm, repetition.
3. After 10 minutes, ask for the details.
4. Discuss which strategy helped most.

Narrative Compression

★★ Assisted

Summarise a 5-sentence story in one sentence from memory.

1. Read a 5-sentence story.
2. Allow 2 minutes' reflection.
3. Each person summarises in one sentence.
4. Compare summaries; discuss what was retained.

Witness Description

★★ Assisted

Study a room scene photo and recall 10 specific details.

1. Show a room photo for 1 minute.
2. Remove photo.
3. Ask 10 questions about the scene.
4. Score 1 per correct detail recalled.



SECTION 2

Attention & Focus

Colour sorting, pattern matching, spot the difference, and sustained attention tasks to improve concentration and vigilance.

- Sustained attention drills
- Selective and divided attention
- Visual scanning and search
- Digit span tasks



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Colour Sorting

★ Independent

Sort coloured objects into groups rapidly and accurately.

1. Mix 20 coloured buttons or blocks.
2. Sort into colour groups as fast as possible.
3. Time the task.
4. Repeat; aim to beat your time.

🎯

Pattern Matching

★ Independent

Find the matching pair in a row of patterns.

1. Show a row of 6 geometric patterns with one duplicate.
2. Participant points to the matching pair.
3. 20 trials; vary patterns.
4. Score 1 per correct match.

👁️

Spot the Difference

★ Independent

Find 5 differences between two nearly identical pictures.

1. Provide two similar pictures side by side.
2. Circle each difference found.
3. Allow 5 minutes.
4. Score 1 per difference found (max 5).

👁️

Sustained Attention Tapping

★★ Assisted

Tap the table every time you hear a target letter in a sequence read aloud.

1. Target letter: A.
2. Facilitator reads random letter sequences.
3. Participant taps on each A.
4. Count hits and false alarms.

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Number Cancellation

★ Independent

Cross out all instances of a target number in a dense number grid.

1. Provide a sheet of random 1-digit numbers.
2. Target: cross out all 7s.
3. Allow 2 minutes.
4. Count hits vs. missed targets.

🔍

Symbol Search

★ Independent

Find target symbols in a row as quickly as possible.

1. Show target symbol (e.g. star) at top of page.
2. Scan row of mixed symbols.
3. Circle each star.
4. Time 3 rows; record results.



Continuous Performance

★★ Assisted

Tap only when a specific two-item sequence appears in a fast-read list.

1. Target: tap when you hear 'A then B' in sequence.
2. Facilitator reads: B, A, A, B, C, A, B…
3. Participant taps only on A-B sequence.
4. Count correct and false taps.



Selective Attention Card Sort

★★ Assisted

Sort cards by shape ignoring their colour to practise selective attention.

1. Provide 20 cards with shapes in various colours.
2. Sort by shape (ignore colour).
3. Sort again by colour (ignore shape).
4. Compare time for each sorting strategy.



Auditory Vigilance

★★ Assisted

Listen to 3 minutes of a story and raise hand each time you hear a target word.

1. Target word: 'the' or a simpler noun.
2. Read a passage at normal pace.
3. Participant signals for each target word.
4. Record hit rate.

👁️

Trail-Making Letters

★★ Assisted

Connect letters in alphabetical order in a scattered array as fast as possible.

1. Provide sheet with letters A–J scattered.
2. Draw a line connecting A to B to C… to J.
3. Time the task.
4. Repeat with a new layout; aim to improve.

🎯

Odd One Out

★ Independent

Identify which item in a group does not belong.

1. Show groups of 4 items: 3 animals, 1 vehicle.
2. Participant circles the odd one.
3. 20 groups; vary categories.
4. Score 1 per correct response.

👁️

Dichotic Listening

★★★ Supported

Listen to two different short lists simultaneously and report target list only.

1. Facilitator reads two 5-word lists simultaneously (one ear each, if headphones; otherwise at same time aloud).
2. Participant reports words from the target ear.
3. Swap target ear.
4. Score recalled items.

👁️

Colour-Word Stroop

★★ Assisted

Name the ink colour of a word, ignoring what the word says (classic Stroop task).

1. Prepare cards: 'RED' written in blue ink.
2. Participant names the ink colour.
3. Aim for 20 cards in 1 minute.
4. Count correct responses.

☁️

Focused Breathing Count

★ Independent

Count breaths up to 10 without losing focus to practise sustained attention.

1. Sit comfortably; close eyes.
2. Count each exhalation.
3. If mind wanders and count is lost, start again from 1.
4. Aim to reach 10 without restart in 5 minutes.

🔢

Digit Span Forward

★ Independent

Immediately repeat a sequence of digits forward.

1. Facilitator reads: 6, 3, 9.
2. Participant repeats immediately.
3. Add one digit per round until 7+ digits.
4. Record maximum span.

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Digit Span Backward

★★ Assisted

Repeat a digit sequence in reverse order.

1. Facilitator reads: 4, 7, 2.
2. Participant repeats backward: 2, 7, 4.
3. Increase length by one per round.
4. Record maximum backward span.

👁️

Listening Comprehension

★ Independent

Listen to a paragraph and answer 3 specific comprehension questions.

1. Read a 4-sentence paragraph aloud.
2. Ask 3 questions: who, what, when.
3. Participant answers without referring to text.
4. Score 1 per correct answer.

👁️

Sustained Visual Search

★ Independent

Find all instances of a target shape in a complex picture.

1. Provide a 'Where's Waldo' style picture.
2. Target: all red hats.
3. Allow 3 minutes.
4. Score 1 per correct find.

🔢

Letter Counting

★ Independent

Count how many times a target letter appears in a paragraph.

1. Choose target letter: E.
2. Read a paragraph; count all E's.
3. Record count.
4. Compare to actual count; discuss strategy.

🎯

Same or Different

★ Independent

Judge whether two patterns shown briefly are the same or different.

1. Flash two patterns for 1 second.
2. Participant calls 'same' or 'different'.
3. 20 trials; vary patterns.
4. Score accuracy.

🔍

Hidden Object Picture

★ Independent

Find all hidden objects in an illustrated picture.

1. Provide a hidden-object picture with 10 items listed.
2. Participant circles each found item.
3. Allow 5 minutes.
4. Score 1 per item found.



Divided Attention Walk

★★ Assisted

Walk a familiar route while performing a verbal task to practise divided attention.

1. Walk along corridor while answering questions.
2. Questions: name 5 animals, months of the year, etc.
3. Rate of walking and accuracy scored.
4. Discuss: which tasks were hardest?



Finger Tapping Sequence

★ Independent

Tap fingers in a precise order as fast as possible to assess attention and motor speed.

1. Index, middle, ring, little, ring, middle, index.
2. Practise slowly.
3. Increase speed.
4. Record 10-second tap count.



Selective Reading

★ Independent

Read a paragraph and underline only sentences containing a target word.

1. Provide a 10-sentence paragraph.
2. Target word: 'and'.
3. Underline every sentence containing it.
4. Check accuracy.

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Time Perception

★ Independent

Estimate how long a 1-minute interval feels without watching a clock.

1. Ask participants to close eyes.
2. Facilitator starts a stopwatch.
3. Participants raise hand when they think 1 minute has passed.
4. Reveal times; discuss differences.

🎯

Attention Bingo

★ Independent

Listen to a long list and mark your card whenever an item matches.

1. Prepare bingo cards with 9 category items.
2. Facilitator reads 30 random category items.
3. Participants mark matches.
4. First to complete a row wins.

🔢

Mental Arithmetic Race

★★ Assisted

Solve simple arithmetic as fast as possible to train mental focus.

1. Facilitator calls: 5+7, 12-4, 3×4, 20÷5.
2. Participants call answer as fast as possible.
3. First correct answer wins the point.
4. Play 15 rounds.

👁️

Stroop Variation

★★ Assisted

Name the shape drawn but only if its colour matches a given rule.

1. Rule: only name shapes drawn in red.
2. Show cards with shapes in various colours.
3. Participant names shape only if red.
4. Count correct responses in 1 minute.

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Concentration Card Game

★ Independent

Classic matching pairs card game to train visual memory and concentration.

1. Lay 20 cards face down in a grid (10 pairs).
2. Turn over two cards; if matching, keep them.
3. If not matching, turn face down.
4. Most pairs wins.

👁️

Visual Scanning Grid

★ Independent

Scan a grid of letters and circle all target letters as fast as possible.

1. Provide a 10×10 grid of random letters.
2. Target: circle all A's and S's.
3. Allow 2 minutes.
4. Count correct finds and misses.



SECTION 3

Language & Communication

Word associations, anagram solving, proverb completion, and story starters to exercise verbal fluency and language processing.

- Word association and fluency
- Anagram and proverb work
- Storytelling and riddles
- Synonym and analogy tasks



Word Association

★ Independent

Respond to a word with the first word that comes to mind, chaining associations.

1. Facilitator says 'sun'.
2. Participant immediately says next association.
3. Continue chain for 10 words.
4. Restart with a new seed word.

Anagram Solving

★★ Assisted

Rearrange scrambled letters to form a word.

1. Present anagram: GRAEND (= GARDEN).
2. Allow 30 seconds per anagram.
3. Facilitator provides clue category if needed.
4. 5 anagrams per session; score correct solves.

Proverb Completion

★ Independent

Complete well-known proverbs from the first few words.

1. Facilitator reads: 'A stitch in time...'
2. Participant completes: '...saves nine'.
3. Discuss meaning of each proverb.
4. 10 proverbs per session.

Story Starters

★ Independent

Continue a story from a given opening line to exercise narrative language.

1. Facilitator reads: 'It was the strangest morning...'
2. Participant continues for 3–4 sentences.
3. Share with group.
4. Vote for most imaginative continuation.

Category Fluency

★ Independent

Name as many items in a category as possible in 60 seconds.

1. Category: animals.
2. Start timer; participant names animals.
3. Count unique, valid responses.
4. Compare scores across categories.

Rhyme Pairs

★ Independent

Find rhyming words for a given word to exercise phonological awareness.

1. Facilitator says: 'hat'.
2. Participant names as many rhymes as possible in 30 seconds.
3. Score 1 per unique rhyme.
4. Progress to less common rhyme words.

Synonym Search

★★ Assisted

Find 3 synonyms for a given word to build vocabulary flexibility.

1. Target word: 'happy'.
2. Participants call synonyms: glad, joyful, cheerful.
3. Score 1 per unique synonym.
4. Try antonyms as a variation.

Letter Fluency

★★ Assisted

Name as many words as possible starting with a given letter in 60 seconds.

1. Target letter: F.
2. Start timer; name F-words.
3. Exclude proper nouns.
4. Count unique valid responses.

Odd Word Out

★ Independent

Identify the word that doesn't fit a category.

1. Read: 'apple, orange, carrot, banana'.
2. Participant identifies 'carrot' as odd.
3. Explain reasoning.
4. 10 rounds; vary categories.



Sentence Completion

★ Independent

Complete a sentence in a meaningful way.

1. Facilitator reads: 'The weather today is...'
2. Participant completes naturally.
3. Move to trickier completions.
4. 10 sentences per session.



Describe an Object

★ Independent

Describe a common object without naming it so others can guess it.

1. Choose a common object.
2. Describe using: colour, size, use, texture.
3. Group guesses what it is.
4. Take turns describing.



Tongue Twisters

★ Independent

Repeat tongue twisters quickly to exercise articulation and phonological focus.

1. Facilitator reads: 'She sells seashells'.
2. Group repeats slowly first.
3. Gradually increase speed.
4. Time 3 perfect repetitions.



Word Building

★★ Assisted

Add prefixes and suffixes to root words to build new vocabulary.

1. Root word: 'happy'.
2. Add prefix: unhappy.
3. Add suffix: happiness.
4. Find 3 variations for each root.



Missing Vowels

★★ Assisted

Identify the word when all vowels are removed.

1. Present: B_RD (BIRD).
2. Participant guesses the word.
3. 15 words per session; vary difficulty.
4. Score 1 per correct guess.



Alphabetical Word Chain

★ Independent

Name animals (or any category) starting with successive letters of the alphabet.

1. Category: animals; start with A.
2. Ant – Bear – Cat – Dog…
3. Skip letters no one can answer.
4. Applaud reaching Z.



Sentence Scramble

★★ Assisted

Rearrange scrambled words into a correct sentence.

1. Present: 'the / garden / blooms / spring / in'.
2. Arrange words into a logical sentence.
3. Multiple correct answers may exist.
4. 10 sentences per session.



Compound Words

★ Independent

Combine two words to make a compound word.

1. Facilitator says: 'sun + flower = ?'
2. Participant answers: sunflower.
3. Take turns generating compound words.
4. Who can find the longest compound?



Riddle Time

★ Independent

Solve verbal riddles to encourage lateral thinking through language.

1. Facilitator reads a riddle: 'I have hands but cannot clap. What am I?'
2. Group has 1 minute to guess.
3. Answer: a clock.
4. 10 riddles per session.

Word Detective

★★ Assisted

Find a small word hidden inside a longer word.

1. Target: 'elephant' contains 'ant'.
2. Facilitator names long words.
3. Participant finds hidden short words.
4. Score 1 per correct hidden word.

Name in a Sentence

★ Independent

Make up a sentence where every word starts with successive letters of your first name.

1. Name: PAT → P, A, T.
2. Create sentence: 'Parrots Always Talk'.
3. Share with group.
4. Applaud creative sentences.

Abbreviation Expansion

★ Independent

Expand well-known abbreviations to their full form.

1. Facilitator says: 'NHS'.
2. Participant: 'National Health Service'.
3. 10 abbreviations per session.
4. Score 1 per correct expansion.

Vocabulary Definition Game

★★ Assisted

Define a word with multiple false definitions and identify the real one.

1. Facilitator reads a word and 3 definitions (2 false, 1 true).
2. Participants vote for which is correct.
3. Reveal answer; award points.
4. 10 words per session.

Verbal Analogy

★★ Assisted

Complete the analogy: 'hot is to cold as day is to...'

1. Present analogy: 'big is to small as tall is to ?'
2. Participant completes: 'short'.
3. 15 analogies per session; vary topics.
4. Discuss reasoning.

Storytelling with Props

★ Independent

Create a 2-minute story incorporating 3 random objects.

1. Draw 3 object cards: umbrella, elephant, violin.
2. Participant creates a 2-minute story including all 3.
3. Group listens and asks one question.
4. Applaud each story.



Opinion Sharing

★ Independent

Share a structured opinion on a simple topic using complete sentences.

1. Topic: 'Is a dog better than a cat as a pet?'
2. Each person shares opinion: 'I think... because...'
3. Respond to each other's points.
4. Summarise group consensus at end.



Word Length Sequencing

★ Independent

Arrange a set of words in order from shortest to longest.

1. Write 6 words on cards varying from 3 to 9 letters.
2. Participants arrange cards by length.
3. Check order.
4. Repeat with new sets.



Metaphor Meaning

★★ Assisted

Explain what common metaphors mean in everyday language.

1. Facilitator: 'It's raining cats and dogs'.
2. Participant explains meaning.
3. Discuss: where did this expression come from?
4. 10 expressions per session.

Backward Letter Recitation

★★ Assisted

Recite the alphabet backward from Z to A to challenge sequential verbal memory.

1. Start from Z.
2. Recite each letter backward.
3. Pause allowed; no penalty.
4. Time each attempt; aim to improve.

Cultural Proverb Share

★ Independent

Share a proverb from your cultural background and explain its meaning.

1. Each person thinks of a proverb from their background.
2. Share the proverb with the group.
3. Explain its meaning and context.
4. Discuss whether others have a similar saying.

Active Listening Practice

★ Independent

Listen to a partner's story and accurately report it back to the group.

1. Pairs: one person tells a 1-minute story.
2. Partner listens without interrupting.
3. Partner reports the story to the group.
4. Storyteller rates accuracy out of 5.



SECTION 4

Executive Function

Planning tasks, problem solving, decision making, and categorisation to maintain higher-order cognitive skills.

- Planning and goal setting
- Problem solving and decisions
- Categorisation and sequencing
- Flexible and abstract thinking



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Meal Planning Task

★★ Assisted

Plan a 3-course meal for 4 people within a budget to practise planning.

1. Budget: £20.
2. Plan starter, main, dessert.
3. Write down dishes and estimated costs.
4. Adjust to fit within budget.

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Priority Sorting

★ Independent

Sort a list of tasks into urgent, important, and neither categories.

1. Provide list of 10 daily tasks.
2. Sort into three piles: do now, plan, skip.
3. Discuss reasoning for each decision.
4. Compare sorts with a partner.

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Problem of the Day

★ Independent

Discuss a common real-life problem and generate 3 possible solutions.

1. Problem: 'Your electricity goes off suddenly'.
2. Brainstorm 3 solutions.
3. Evaluate each solution: pros and cons.
4. Choose best solution and explain why.

Decision Tree

★★ Assisted

Map out a simple decision using a branching yes/no tree.

1. Decision: should I go for a walk today?
2. Draw Yes/No branch.
3. For Yes: what should I wear? Branch again.
4. Complete the tree; discuss the final choice.

Recipe Sequencing

★ Independent

Place recipe steps in the correct order.

1. Provide 8 recipe step cards in scrambled order.
2. Arrange steps in logical order.
3. Read through the sequence.
4. Discuss: what would happen if steps were in wrong order?

Event Planning

★★ Assisted

Plan a simple party including invitations, food, and decorations.

1. Occasion: birthday party for 10 people.
2. List: invitations, food menu, decorations.
3. Assign tasks to group members.
4. Discuss timing: what must be done first?

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Map Reading

★★ Assisted

Read a simple map and plan a route from A to B.

1. Provide a simple town-grid map.
2. Mark start (A) and destination (B).
3. Plan shortest route.
4. Identify street names on the route.

🎯

Categorisation Challenge

★ Independent

Sort objects into multiple categories simultaneously.

1. Provide 15 object cards: animals, tools, food.
2. Sort into 3 correct categories.
3. Time the sort.
4. Re-sort using a different categorisation rule.

🎯

Consequence Thinking

★ Independent

Discuss the likely consequences of a given action.

1. Action: 'What would happen if it rained for a whole month?'
2. Generate 5 consequences.
3. Rate each as positive or negative.
4. Discuss long-term effects.

Analogy Planning

★★ Assisted

Use a familiar analogy to solve an unfamiliar planning problem.

1. Problem: organising a library of 100 books.
2. Analogy: like sorting laundry by colour.
3. Apply analogy: group books by topic.
4. Plan the sorting steps.

Error Detection

★ Independent

Find errors in a short text or list of instructions.

1. Provide a paragraph with 5 deliberate factual errors.
2. Participants read and underline errors.
3. Compare findings.
4. Score 1 per error found.

Shopping Budget

★★ Assisted

Choose items from a shopping list that fit within a set budget.

1. Budget: £15. List: 10 items with prices.
2. Select items totalling no more than £15.
3. Justify each choice.
4. Compare selections with a partner.

Safety Check

★ Independent

Identify safety hazards in a described scenario.

1. Scenario: 'You are cooking on the stove and the phone rings'.
2. List 3 safety risks.
3. Describe what you would do for each.
4. Discuss safest course of action.

Daily Schedule Design

★ Independent

Create a realistic daily schedule for a hypothetical person.

1. Person: a retired teacher who wants to stay active.
2. Plan activities for morning, afternoon, evening.
3. Include exercise, social, and rest time.
4. Evaluate: is the schedule realistic?

Moral Dilemma Discussion

★★ Assisted

Discuss a simple moral dilemma and reason through the decision.

1. Dilemma: 'You find a wallet with £50 and an address. What do you do?'
2. Each person states their choice.
3. Give reasons using 'I think... because...'
4. Discuss differing perspectives.

🎯

Multi-Step Instructions

★★ Assisted

Follow 5-step written instructions to complete a task.

1. Provide written instructions for folding origami or another simple task.
2. Read all steps before starting.
3. Complete the task in order.
4. Evaluate result.

🎯

Flexible Thinking

★★ Assisted

Name as many uses as possible for a common object to practise divergent thinking.

1. Object: a brick.
2. List all possible uses in 2 minutes.
3. Compare lists with group.
4. Award a point for each unique use.

🎯

What Would You Do?

★ Independent

Respond to hypothetical everyday scenarios to practise situational judgment.

1. Scenario: 'You smell smoke coming from a neighbour's house'.
2. Participant explains step-by-step response.
3. Group discusses alternatives.
4. Identify the safest first action.

Reverse Planning

★★ Assisted

Work backward from a goal to identify the steps needed to achieve it.

1. Goal: arrive at doctor's office at 10 am.
2. What must happen just before? Leave home.
3. Before that? Get dressed, eat breakfast.
4. Continue backward to when to wake up.

Pros and Cons Table

★ Independent

List pros and cons of a decision using a structured table.

1. Decision: move to a smaller home.
2. Create two columns: pros and cons.
3. List at least 3 items per column.
4. Decide based on the table.

Time Estimation Task

★★ Assisted

Estimate how long common activities take and compare to actual.

1. List: boil kettle, walk 1 km, read one page.
2. Participants estimate each in minutes.
3. Compare estimates.
4. Discuss which were over or underestimated.

Logical Sequencing

★ Independent

Arrange events in chronological order.

1. Provide 6 event cards: seed grows into plant.
2. Arrange in logical order.
3. Justify the sequence.
4. Find the step that was hardest to place.

Task Switching Practice

★★ Assisted

Alternate rapidly between two different classification rules.

1. Rule 1: sort by colour. Rule 2: sort by shape.
2. Facilitator calls 'switch' every 30 seconds.
3. Participant sorts by current rule.
4. Count errors per switch.

Goal Setting

★ Independent

Set a small realistic personal goal for the coming week.

1. Think of one achievable goal: 'walk outside every day'.
2. Make it specific: 'walk for 10 minutes after breakfast'.
3. Write it down.
4. Report back next session: how did it go?

Abstract Reasoning

★★★ Supported

Identify the rule in a series of shapes and predict the next one.

1. Show series: circle, square, triangle, circle, square...
2. Ask: what comes next?
3. Explain the rule observed.
4. Increase complexity: add size or colour variations.

Cause and Effect Chains

★★ Assisted

Build a 4-step cause-and-effect chain from a given starting event.

1. Start: 'It rains heavily'.
2. Next: 'Roads flood'.
3. Next: 'Car delays occur'.
4. Final effect: '?'. Group completes chain.

Self-Monitoring Quiz

★ Independent

Rate your own performance on a task before and after completing it.

1. Before starting: rate confidence from 1–5.
2. Complete a short memory task.
3. After: rate actual performance.
4. Compare pre and post ratings.

Innovation Challenge

★★ Assisted

Suggest an improvement to a familiar everyday object.

1. Object: an umbrella.
2. Brainstorm 3 improvements.
3. Share ideas with group.
4. Vote for most practical improvement.

Perspective Taking

★ Independent

Describe a situation from another person's point of view.

1. Situation: a child starts a new school.
2. Describe from child's perspective.
3. Describe from teacher's perspective.
4. Compare: what concerns are different?

Planning Under Constraints

★★ Assisted

Plan an outing with specific limitations (no car, rainy day, £10 budget).

1. Constraints: no car, raining, £10.
2. Plan a satisfying afternoon out.
3. List specific activities and locations.
4. Discuss: what was hardest to accommodate?